



Grace for Educators

A professional-growth pathway for the people who do the work — because you can't pour relationship from an empty cup.

Relationship-centered teaching asks a lot of a person. This pathway turns the four pillars — **Identity, Self-Compassion, Forgiveness, and Grace** — toward the educator: protecting your sense of purpose, guarding against compassion fatigue and burnout, giving you a clean way to repair hard interactions, and building a staff culture of trust and leadership through grace. Use the modules solo, or run the team activities and protocols at a staff meeting or PD day.

THE FOUR EDUCATOR MODULES

- **Identity** — teacher identity & relationship-centered teaching.
- **Self-Compassion** — compassion fatigue, burnout prevention, wellness.
- **Forgiveness** — repairing difficult interactions, with students and colleagues.
- **Grace** — staff trust, team culture, leadership through grace.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- Reflection exercises for individual use.
- Team-meeting activities and staff discussion protocols.
- Four PD modules and a leadership reflection toolkit.
- Quick wellness check-ins for the rhythm of a school year.

A TWO-MINUTE STAFF WELLNESS CHECK-IN

Open any meeting with one round: "**One word for your tank today — full, fine, or running low.**" No fixing, no follow-up required. Naming it is the practice. A staff that can say "running low" out loud is a staff that catches burnout before it catches them.

Teacher Identity & Relationship-Centered Teaching

Why you came, who you are in the room, and the relationships at the center of the work.

REFLECTION EXERCISES

- Write your "why I teach" in one sentence. Compare it to how you spent last Tuesday.
- Name a student who changed because of your relationship, not your lesson plan. What did you do?
- Identify the gap between the teacher you meant to be and the one the workload made you.

JOURNALING / WELLNESS PROMPTS

- "When did I last feel like the teacher I set out to be?"
- "Which relationships in my room am I investing in — and which am I avoiding?"
- "What part of my identity is mine, versus assigned by the system?"

TEAM-MEETING ACTIVITY — "WHY WE CAME"

Pairs share their one-sentence "why I teach," then the group surfaces the common threads on the board. Close by naming one way the team can protect those reasons this month. **10–15 minutes.** Rebuilds shared purpose fast — especially mid-year.

GROWTH MOVE — RELATIONSHIP AS THE METHOD

Relationship-centered teaching isn't extra work on top of instruction — it *is* the instruction's foundation. The two minutes you spend greeting a struggling student by name buys back twenty minutes of compliance battles later. Protect the relationship and the rest gets easier.

Compassion Fatigue, Burnout & Wellness

Caring is renewable — but only if you tend the source.

REFLECTION EXERCISES

- Map your week's energy: what fills the tank, what drains it, what's non-negotiable.
- Spot your early burnout signals (cynicism, dread, numbness). Name your first one.
- List three things only you can do — and three you've been carrying that someone else could.

WELLNESS CHECK-INS

- Daily: "Full / fine / running low?" — and one small refill if low.
- Weekly: "What did I do this week that was just for me?"
- Seasonal: a tank-check at each grading period; adjust before empty.

TEAM-MEETING ACTIVITY — "THE HONEST TANK"

Each person rates their tank 1–5 anonymously (sticky notes in a jar). Average them, post it, and as a team choose **one** collective drain to reduce this month — a meeting to cut, a duty to share, an expectation to lower. **Compassion fatigue is a team condition, treated with team decisions.**

GROWTH MOVE — FLIP THE EDUCATOR CRITIC

The voice that says "a good teacher would have reached that kid" is the same critic your students fight. Talk to yourself like you'd talk to a first-year teacher you admire. Self-compassion isn't lowering the bar — it's staying in the profession long enough to clear it.

Repairing Difficult Interactions

With a student, a parent, or a colleague — the clean way back.

REFLECTION EXERCISES

- Recall an interaction you'd redo. Walk the four steps: **own it** · **name the impact** · **make it right** · **reset**.
- Name a student you've quietly written off. What would one repair look like?
- Identify a colleague tension you've been avoiding. What's the cost of leaving it?

JOURNALING PROMPTS

- "When I lose patience with a student, what's usually true about my own day?"
- "What grudge am I carrying in this building, and what's it costing my teaching?"
- "Who do I owe a redo — and what's stopping me?"

STAFF DISCUSSION PROTOCOL — "THE REPAIR ROUND"

- 1 **Name it safely.** One person shares a hard interaction; the group listens without fixing.
- 2 **Find the need.** Together, name what each party was likely needing underneath.
- 3 **Walk the steps.** Draft a real four-step repair the person could actually use.
- 4 **Normalize it.** Close by sharing that everyone in the room has owed a redo. Repair becomes culture, not failure.

GROWTH MOVE — REPAIR IN FRONT OF STUDENTS

When you repair with a class — "I was short with you yesterday; that wasn't fair, and I'm sorry" — you don't lose authority. You model the single most important relationship skill they'll ever need, and you make your room safe to make mistakes in.

Staff Trust, Team Culture & Leadership Through Grace

The culture the adults build is the culture the students inherit.

LEADERSHIP REFLECTION TOOLS

- "Do my staff experience me as connection-before-correction, or the reverse?"
- "Where am I assuming the worst about a struggling colleague?"
- "What would it look like to extend a teacher the grace I ask them to extend students?"

TEAM-MEETING ACTIVITY — "GRACE WE RECEIVED"

- Open with each person naming one moment a colleague had their back.
- Send one written thank-you to someone in the building this week.
- Name one team norm that would make trust easier; adopt it.

STAFF DISCUSSION PROTOCOL — "BENEFIT OF THE DOUBT"

When a staff frustration surfaces (a missed deadline, a tense email), the team pauses and generates **three kind reasons** the person might have acted that way before responding. It rewires a building from suspicion to trust — and models exactly what we ask teachers to do with students.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT PATHWAY

SESSION 1

Identity

Reconnect to purpose; relationship-centered teaching as method.

SESSION 2

Self-Compassion

Burnout literacy; team-level tank checks and refills.

SESSION 3

Forgiveness

The Repair Round; making redos normal in the building.

SESSION 4

Grace

Trust norms; leadership through grace; sustaining the culture.

LEADERSHIP CHALLENGE — MODEL IT FIRST

Staff culture is caught, not mandated. For one month, lead with the four pillars yourself: name a teacher's character out loud (Identity), normalize your own tank running low (Self-Compassion), repair a misstep with staff (Forgiveness), and open every meeting with connection before the agenda (Grace). The building will follow what it sees you do.